Homage Landmark Strategy Notes

How landmark-based interaction could work for Homage without simply copying Pokemon Go.

Core idea: a landmark becomes a meaningful creative anchor. Pokemon Go asks what game action should happen here. Homage asks what this place can help someone notice, write, preserve, or unlock.

1. The Basic Shift

Pokemon Go uses landmarks as game nodes: Gyms, PokeStops, raids, item drops, and social gathering points. Homage can use landmarks as creative and documentary nodes: writing sites, local archives, memory stations, artifact drops, or sky-observation points.

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Instead of landmark = Gym, Homage can treat a landmark as landmark = writing site / document altar / local archive / memory node.
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2. Practical Landmark Uses

Idea	How Homage could use it
Place-based writing prompts	When someone is near a landmark, Document Studio can offer a prompt shaped by that place: a courthouse, mural, bridge, park, library, trail, or historic marker.
Local document drops	A user can publish a PDF or artifact at a location. Other users near that landmark can discover it later.
Landmark archives	A landmark can accumulate documents over time, becoming a small local literary archive.
Safer quest generation	The app can prefer public, pedestrian-accessible places and avoid roads, private homes, highways, shoulders, and restricted areas.
Template selection	The app can suggest document templates based on landmark type: field journal, ekphrastic poem, civic reflection, walking poem, elegy, annotation, or local memory.
Puzzle unlocks	A landmark document can include a clue or observation question. Solving it unlocks a PDF, song, or artifact.
Sky pairing	Later, a landmark can pair with the sky view: align a constellation, sunset, Moon, or planet from a safe open place.
Personal landmarks	Private landmarks can support personal writing: a porch, bench, corner, field, or meaningful ordinary place.

3. Examples

- Library: create a reading note, marginalia page, or public bookplate.
- Public art: write an ekphrastic poem that responds to the artwork.
- Park: write a field journal entry with weather, light, and attention notes.
- Bridge: write a crossing story about distance, repair, return, or threshold.
- Historic marker: write an annotation, counter-history, or memory correction.
- Courthouse: write a civic reflection or public record fragment.
- Trail: create a walking poem that unfolds from one point to another.
- Water: write a current, tide, weather, or reflection note.

4. Technical Shape

Homage could collect landmark candidates from OpenStreetMap, public art tags, parks, trails, water features, civic buildings, historic markers, bridges, libraries, curated local lists, and user-created private landmarks.

SQLite could store landmark metadata while files remain on disk. Documents and artifacts would link to landmark ids.

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landmarks: landmark_id, name, category, latitude, longitude, source, access_policy, created_at,
payload_json documents/artifacts: document_id, landmark_id, title, file_url, created_at,
payload_json
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With that shape, Homage can ask: what documents exist near this landmark, what prompts fit this landmark type, what has this user created here, and what is safe to show nearby?

5. Safety And Privacy Rules

1. Prefer public and pedestrian-accessible landmarks.
2. Keep backend safety policy authoritative.
3. Avoid destinations that require stopping a vehicle, crossing unsafe roads, entering private property, or lingering in restricted areas.
4. Treat personal landmarks as private by default.
5. Separate GPS readiness from human safety confirmation.
6. Allow offline/local-first storage, then sync or publish only when appropriate.

6. Recommended Product Direction

The strongest Homage version is not a Pokemon Go clone. It is a literary, documentary, local-first layer over the world. Landmarks should become anchors for attention and creation rather than just game mechanics.

1. Start with Document Studio prompts tied to safe, public landmark categories.
2. Save landmark-linked documents as local artifacts.
3. Add a landmark archive view later.
4. Add puzzle unlocks only after the document loop feels solid.

5. Return to sky pairing only when the sky lens becomes an active priority again.

North star: use landmarks to help people notice, write, preserve, and revisit the meaning of places.